

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

THE CEO OF REALTOR.COM JUST TOLD AGENTS WHO PUSH PRIVATE LISTINGS THEY'RE ON THE WRONG SIDE OF HISTORY.

He's right. But one word in his argument gives away his real motive.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**CHOICE ONLY
COUNTS WHEN THE
SELLER KNOWS
THE COST.**

That's the tell in the private-listing pitch every agent needs to hear.

HIS NAME IS DAMIAN EALES, CEO OF REALTOR.COM.

This week he drew a line. A home is most of a family's wealth, and hiding it from the market for a quiet deal isn't serving that family. It's the agent putting commission ahead of the client's price.

"YEARS FROM NOW, YOU'RE ON THE RIGHT SIDE OF THIS OR THE WRONG ONE."

Eales calls it a right side of history test.

EALES RUNS A LISTING SITE.

Open listings are his business model. He benefits from saying this out loud.

THE TELL ISN'T HIS MOTIVE. IT'S THE PITCH.

Agents call it "seller choice." But choice only counts when the seller knows the cost: fewer buyers, fewer offers, almost always a lower number.

WHAT TO DO AT YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

- 1** Stop offering private as an equal option.
- 2** Lead with full exposure as your recommendation.
- 3** If they still want quiet, put it in writing that you advised against it.

THE TAKEAWAY

**PULL YOUR LAST
PRIVATE-LISTING
CONVERSATION.
DID YOU LEAD
WITH EXPOSURE,
OR DID YOU OFFER
IT AS A NEUTRAL
MENU ITEM?**

Years from now, your file shows which side you were on.